

Treatment of wh-expletives in Haryanvi

Madan Mohan

Department of Linguistics, University of Delhi

mmohangupta277@gmail.com

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22208168>

This paper examines long-distance wh-dependencies in Haryanvi, an Indo-Aryan language of northern India, and in particular the construction in which the element ke appears in the matrix clause while the interrogative phrase remains in situ in the embedded clause. Haryanvi patterns with Hindi-Urdu in allowing two strategies for forming a long-distance wh-dependency: the wh-phrase may move into the matrix clause, or it may stay in the subordinate clause, in which case ke surfaces preverbally in the matrix clause. Drawing on data elicited from native speakers, I establish that the Haryanvi construction obeys the generalisations that have been reported for Hindi-Urdu: the scope of any number of embedded wh-phrases can be extended, a scope marker and a true wh-phrase cannot occur in the same clause, a scope marker must appear in every intervening clause, and the matrix clause can contain neither the sentential expletive yo nor negation. Against this background I argue that ke is not a scope marker at all. It is a wh-expletive that questions the sentential expletive yo, which is base-generated at the edge of the embedded CP and co-indexed with it. Both elements raise to the edge of the matrix vP, so that the surface order follows without the embedded wh-phrase taking matrix scope. The account therefore leaves the wh-in-situ character of Haryanvi and Hindi-Urdu intact.

Keywords: wh-expletive, wh-scope marking, wh-in-situ, Haryanvi, Hindi-Urdu

1 Introduction

This paper is concerned with wh-expletive constructions in Haryanvi, an Indo-Aryan language spoken in the state of Haryana in northern India.¹ The construction is considered throughout in comparison with the closely related Hindi-Urdu. On the surface Haryanvi looks like a wh-in-situ language: it has SOV word order, and no overt wh-movement is found in interrogative sentences.

- (1) a. Haryanvi Raam soʃ-ε sε ək Bhavya a:-ji: sε.
 Ram think-PRS be.PRS COMP Bhavya come-PFV.F be.PRS
 ‘Ram thinks that Bhavya has come.’
- b. Raam ke soʃ-ε sε ək koŋ a:-ja: sε?
 Ram EXPL think-PRS be.PRS COMP who come-PFV.M be.PRS
 ‘Who does Ram think has come?’

Cheng (1991: 19) defines a wh-in-situ language as one which allows the wh-word in a wh-question to stay in situ, and proposes that in such languages wh-movement takes place at LF. The aim of this paper is to look for covert or overt movement of this kind in Haryanvi and to

¹ The Haryanvi data reported here were elicited from two native speakers of the language. Haryanvi examples are given in a broad phonetic transcription and are therefore not italicised; Hindi-Urdu examples are given in the transliteration used in the sources from which they are taken.

account for whatever construction is found. In particular, the paper examines whether the movement in question is motivated by scope, as has been reported for other wh-in-situ languages and especially for the languages of South Asia, or whether some other explanation is available.

Long-distance wh-dependencies can be formed in two ways in Haryanvi. In the first, shown in (2) for Haryanvi and in (4) for Hindi-Urdu, the whole wh-phrase which was base-generated in the subordinate clause is moved into the matrix clause.

- (2) Haryanvi Raam-ne kis-ṭi soṭṭja: ək Bhavya-ne — ḍekhya:?
 Ram-ERG who-ACC think.PST COMP Bhavya-ERG see.PST
 ‘Who did Ram think that Bhavya saw?’

In the second way of forming a long-distance wh-dependency, shown in (3) for Haryanvi and in (5) for Hindi-Urdu, the wh-phrase does not move out of the subordinate clause and remains in situ. The position of this wh-phrase is preverbal. In the matrix clause, the wh-expletive *ke* shows up in the preverbal position.

- (3) Haryanvi Raam-ne ke soṭṭja: ək Bhavya-ne kis-ṭi ḍekhya:?
 Ram-ERG EXPL think.PST COMP Bhavya-ERG who-ACC see.PST
 ‘Who did Ram think that Bhavya saw?’

- (4) Hindi-Urdu Sita-ne kis-ko soca: ki Ravi:-ne — dekha:?
 Sita-ERG who-ACC think.PST COMP Ravi-ERG see.PST
 ‘Who did Sita think that Ravi saw?’

- (5) Hindi-Urdu Sita-ne kya: soca: ki Ravi:-ne kis-ko dekha:?
 Sita-ERG EXPL think.PST COMP Ravi-ERG who-ACC see.PST
 ‘Who did Sita think that Ravi saw?’

In earlier work on wh-movement, constituents were held to move through a sequence of intermediate positions, and in particular through the CP layer of each containing clause. Later research showed that CP is not the only intermediate position at which movement can take place. Chomsky (2000), in developing the notion of phase, accords the same status to CP and to vP, and therefore takes the edge of vP to be a landing site for long-distance movement in addition to Spec,CP.

Wh-expletives, like the expletives of the A-movement system, do not have the full feature specification of a true wh-word, in the sense that they carry only uninterpretable features and lack an interpretation (Chomsky 2000). When a wh-expletive is merged into the specifier of a functional head, CP or vP, by External Merge, its wh-features can enter into an Agree relation with an in-situ wh-phrase in its domain.

Three approaches to wh-expletives and scope-marking constructions are current in the literature: the direct dependency approach, the indirect dependency approach and the mixed dependency approach. These are set out in §5. Before turning to them it is necessary to establish the properties of wh-dependencies in Haryanvi and in the related Hindi-Urdu, which is the task of §3 and §4.

2 Haryanvi

The name of the language is identical with the name of the state. The use of retroflex sounds is prominent in it. The districts adjoining Rajasthan speak different varieties of Haryanvi, as in Gurugram, while Mewati (Haryanvi) is spoken in Mewat district, and significant differences in language can be found along the borders of the Bhiwani, Hisar and Rewari districts. There is a large population of Haryanvi speakers in Pakistan as well: many speakers moved there at Partition, and even there they maintained the status of their native language.

Haryanvi has a number of dialects. The most widely known are Bangaru, also known as Jattu, ‘the language of the Jats’, which is spoken in areas close to the Yamuna river, together with Khadar and Deswali. The variety of Haryanvi spoken in the districts of Bhiwani, Hisar and Sirsa is known as Bagri or Bagdi. Haryanvi is commonly understood to be a dialect of Hindi rather than a separate language, and it has many similarities with Khariboli and Braj Bhasha, although variation can still be found from place to place within a single district.

3 Wh-dependencies in Haryanvi and Hindi-Urdu

Hindi-Urdu and Haryanvi both have an unmarked word order which is verb-final, and in a transitive sentence the subject comes before the object.

- (6) a. Hindi-Urdu *Arjun ghar gyaa.*
Arjun home go.PST.M
‘Arjun went home.’
- b. *Rani-ne driver-ko chaabii dii.*
Rani-ERG driver-DAT key give.PST.F
‘Rani gave the key to the driver.’
- c. Haryanvi *Raam ghrā: gyaa.*
Ram home go.PST.M
‘Ram went home.’
- d. *Sita-ne mehma:nā-ti: t̪ja: d̪i:.*
Sita-ERG guest.PL-DAT tea give.PST.F
‘Sita gave tea to the guests.’

Hindi-Urdu is usually described as a wh-in-situ language. The unmarked position for the interrogative phrase is immediately before the sentence-final verb, whatever grammatical role the phrase has (Schmidt 1999; Kidwai 2000; Bhatt 2003). Haryanvi shows the interrogative phrase in the same position.

- (7) a. Hindi-Urdu *bacche-ko kis-ne maaraa?*
child-ACC who-ERG hit.PST
‘Who hit the child?’
- b. *Raam-ne kya: dekha:?*
Ram-ERG what see.PST
‘What did Ram see?’

- c. Haryanvi ba:lək-t̪i: kis-nɛ ma:rja:ʔ
 child-ACC who-ERG hit.PST
 ‘Who hit the child?’
- d. Sita-nɛ kis-t̪i: ap̪i: naji: kiṭa:b dikha:i:ʔ
 Sita-ERG who-DAT REFL.POSS.F new book show.PST.F
 ‘To whom did Sita show her new book?’

Hindi-Urdu allows relatively free scrambling of constituents, so that the sentences in (6) and (7) have a variety of other word orders with various interpretations (Mahajan 1990, 1994; Dayal 1994; Kidwai 2000). The same applies to the Haryanvi examples given here, since Haryanvi also permits scrambling, although the restrictions on leftward and rightward scrambling in the language remain open for research. For present purposes the focus is kept on the unmarked word order alone.

The subordinating particle *ki* optionally precedes embedded clauses in Hindi-Urdu. Finite embedded clauses obligatorily appear to the right of the verb, whereas noun complements appear to its left (Dayal 1996). Haryanvi uses the subordinating particle *ək*, which precedes the finite embedded clause, and here too the embedded clause appears to the right of the verb.

- (8) a. Hindi-Urdu *Vo ja:nti: hai [ki Anu a:yi:].*
 she know.PRS.F be.PRS COMP Anu come.PST.F
 ‘She knows that Anu came.’
- b. **Vo [ki Anu a:yi:] ja:nti: hai.*
 she COMP Anu come.PST.F know.PRS.F be.PRS
 (intended: ‘She knows that Anu came.’)
- c. Haryanvi us-nɛ bera: sɛ [ək Shyam a:ya:].
 3SG-DAT knowledge be.PRS COMP Shyam come.PST.M
 ‘He knows that Shyam came.’
- d. ?us-nɛ [ək Shyam a:ya:] bera: sɛ.
 3SG-DAT COMP Shyam come.PST.M knowledge be.PRS
 (intended: ‘He knows that Shyam came.’)

It has often been claimed that the finite clauses which occur to the right of the verb selecting the embedded clause in Hindi-Urdu do not originate in that position, but have somehow been extraposed (Davison 1988) or else adjoined to CP or IP (Dayal 1996; Lahiri 2002). It appears as if these clauses are c-commanded by material in the matrix clause. For example, even when a *wh*-expletive appears in the matrix clause, a quantifier in the matrix clause can bind a pronoun in the embedded clause (Mahajan 2000). If the CP complement were adjoined, this would be unexpected, since the *wh*-expletive *kyaa* would then occupy the only complement position associated with the verb. While movement of *wh*-phrases is possible out of complement CPs, it is impossible for CPs that are clearly adjuncts to undergo movement, a fact that Bayer (1996) discusses for both Hindi-Urdu and Bangla. It will therefore be maintained that finite clauses are complements in Hindi-Urdu even though they appear to the right of the verb, and similar reasoning can be given for Haryanvi.

Given these facts, it is reasonable to assume that the transitive light verb *v* and the VP projection are both head-final, and that the verb takes nominal and CP complements to its left, as in Figure 1.

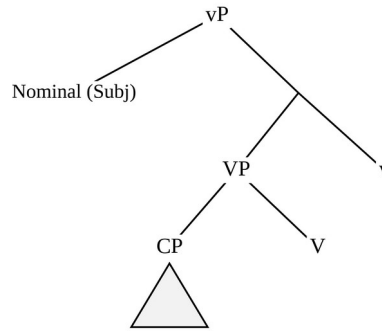


Figure 1: Head-final v and V taking a CP complement to the left (after Manetta 2010)

When a verb takes a finite complement clause in Hindi-Urdu, an interrogative phrase originating in the embedded clause can take matrix scope in two ways. It can move out of its original position into the matrix clause, or it can remain in situ, in which case the apparently meaningless *kyaa* appears in the matrix clause. Wh-material (wh-phrases and wh-expletives alike) appears in the preverbal position in both Hindi-Urdu and Haryanvi. According to Manetta (2010), the preverbal position of wh-material in Hindi-Urdu must be significantly lower than CP; and if the verb is itself within vP, then the wh-material is in an A'-position relatively close to the verb.

4 Generalisations about the wh-expletive construction

This section sets out the properties of the wh-expletive construction in Haryanvi alongside the corresponding Hindi-Urdu facts reported in the literature.

4.1 Extension of scope

A wh-expletive extends the scope of a wh-phrase in an embedded clause, as shown in (9) and (11). The scope of any number of wh-phrases in an embedded clause can be extended, as shown in (10) and (12).

- (9) Haryanvi Raam-ne ke soṭṭja: ək Bhavya-ne kis-ṭi ḍekhya:?
 Ram-ERG EXPL think.PST COMP Bhavya-ERG who-ACC see.PST
 ‘Who did Ram think that Bhavya saw?’ (= (3))

- (10) Haryanvi Raam ke soṭṭε se [koŋ kre ja:vεga:]?
 Ram EXPL think.PRS be.PRS who where go.FUT.M
 ‘Who does Ram think will go where?’

- (11) Hindi-Urdu Siitaa-ne kyaa socaa [ki ravii-ne kis-ko dekhaa]?
 Sita-ERG EXPL think.PST COMP Ravi-ERG who-ACC see.PST
 ‘Who did Sita think that Ravi saw?’ (Mahajan 2000: 319)

- (12) Hindi-Urdu John kyaa soctaa hai [kaun kahaaN jaayegaa]?
 John EXPL think.PRS.M be.PRS who where go.FUT.M
 ‘Who does John think will go where?’ (Dayal 1994: 140)

4.2 Anti-locality

A wh-expletive and a true wh-element cannot occur in the same clause (Müller 1997), as (13) shows.

- (13) Haryanvi *Raam-nε kis-t̥i ke soʈʃja: ək Bhavya-nε ɖɛkha:?
Ram-ERG who-ACC EXPL think.PST COMP Bhavya-ERG see.PST
(intended: ‘Who did Ram think that Bhavya saw?’)

4.3 Position of the wh-expletive

The wh-expletive occupies a position consistent with being focused. In Hindi-Urdu, a wh-in-situ language, this means that the wh-expletive appears preverbally, and the same holds for Haryanvi.

- (14) Haryanvi Raam-nε ibbe ke soʈʃja: ək Bhavya-nε kis-t̥i ɖɛkha:?
Ram-ERG now EXPL think.PST COMP Bhavya-ERG who-ACC see.PST
‘Who did Ram think just now that Bhavya saw?’

- (15) Haryanvi #Raam-nε ke ibbe soʈʃja: ək Bhavya-nε kis-t̥i ɖɛkha:?
Ram-ERG what now think.PST COMP Bhavya-ERG who-ACC see.PST
(intended: ‘Who did Ram think just now that Bhavya saw?’)

In (15), *ke* does not act as an expletive when the adverb comes after it and before the matrix verb.² It is interpreted instead as a full wh-phrase. In Hindi-Urdu the corresponding order is reported to be ungrammatical, as the contrast between (16) and (17) shows.

- (16) Hindi-Urdu *Sitaa-ne kyaa socaa, ki Ravii-ne kis-ko dekhaa?*
Sita-ERG EXPL think.PST COMP Ravi-ERG who-ACC see.PST
‘Who does Sita think Ravi saw?’ (Mahajan 2000: 317)

- (17) Hindi-Urdu **Siitaa-ne kyaa abhii abhii socaa,*
Sita-ERG EXPL now now think.PST
ki ravii-ne kis-ko dekhaa?
COMP Ravi-ERG who-ACC see.PST
(intended: ‘Who did Sita think just now that Ravi saw?’) (Mahajan 2000: 319)

4.4 Relative positions of wh-expletives and true wh-phrases

A true wh-phrase may appear in any clause below the one containing a wh-expletive, but it will never appear in a clause higher than the one containing a wh-expletive.

- (18) Haryanvi *[koŋ kɾɛ ja:vɛga:] Raam ke soʈʃɛ sɛ?
who where go.FUT.M Ram EXPL think.PRS be.PRS
(intended: ‘Who does Ram think will go where?’)

² The diacritic # marks a string that is well formed but unavailable on the intended scope-marking reading.

- (19) Hindi-Urdu **kon kahaan jaayegaa John kyaa sochtaa hai?*
 who where go.FUT.M John EXPL think.PRS.M be.PRS
 (intended: ‘Who does John think will go where?’)

4.5 Wh-expletives in intervening clauses

Wh-expletives may appear in any clause which intervenes between the wh-expletive in the matrix clause and the embedded clause containing the true wh-phrase. The question arises whether this can be stated more strongly, as a requirement that a wh-expletive cannot be separated from a true wh-phrase by intervening clauses which do not themselves contain a wh-expletive. In Hindi-Urdu it is indeed true that wh-expletives must appear in every clause between the true wh-phrase and the highest occurrence of the wh-expletive, and Haryanvi behaves in the same way.

- (20) Hindi-Urdu *Raam-ne kyaa socaa, [ki ravii-ne *(kyaa)*
 Ram-ERG EXPL think.PST COMP Ravi-ERG EXPL
kahaa, [ki kon sa aadmii aayaa thaa]]?
 say.PST COMP which ATTR.M man come.PST be.PST
 ‘Which man did Ram think that Ravi said came?’ (Mahajan 2000: 322)

- (21) Haryanvi *Raam-nē ke soṭṭja: [ək Shyam-nē *(ke)*
 Ram-ERG EXPL think.PST COMP Shyam-ERG EXPL
bolja:, [ək koṇ sa: a:ḍmi: a:ja: se]]?
 say.PST COMP which ATTR.M man come.PFV.M be.PRS
 ‘Which man did Ram think that Shyam said has come?’

4.6 Wh-expletives and non-wh sentential expletives

Sentential non-wh expletives cannot co-occur with wh-expletives.

- (22) Hindi-Urdu **Sitaa-ne yeh kyaa socaa, ki ravii-ne kis-ko dekhaa?*
 Sita-ERG this EXPL think.PST COMP Ravi-ERG who-ACC see.PST
 (intended: ‘Who did Sita think that Ravi saw?’) (Mahajan 2000: 319)
- (23) Haryanvi **Sita-nē yo ke soṭṭja: ək Shyam-nē kis-ṭi ḍekhya:?*
 Sita-ERG this EXPL think.PST COMP Shyam-ERG who-ACC see.PST
 (intended: ‘Who did Sita think that Shyam saw?’)

4.7 Wh-expletives and negation

A matrix clause containing a wh-expletive cannot be negated and cannot contain a negative operator.

- (24) Hindi-Urdu **koi-bhii-nahii kyaa sochtaa thaa, ki kon aayegaa?*
 anyone-FOC-NEG EXPL think.PRS.M be.PST COMP who come.FUT.M
 (intended: ‘Who did no one think will come?’)

- (25) Haryanvi *koi na ke soʃʃɛ ʈʰa: ək koŋ a:vɛga:?
 anyone NEG EXPL think.PRS be.PST COMP who come.FUT.M
 (intended: ‘Who did no one think will come?’)

5 Wh-scope marking

This section reviews the wh-scope marking construction and the three approaches to it that are current in the literature.

5.1 The wh-scope marking construction

Three strategies for forming wh-questions are found in the languages of the world: all wh-phrases remain in situ, as in Korean; all wh-phrases undergo wh-movement, as in Bulgarian; or one wh-phrase undergoes wh-movement while all other wh-phrases remain in situ, as in English. A great number of languages use wh-scope marking to construct long-distance wh-dependencies. In a wh-scope marking construction, a wh-element α that usually takes the shape of ‘what’ in the language concerned appears in the clause that hosts what seems to be the LF target position for a wh-phrase β , while β itself stays in a lower clause embedded by a verb that takes [–wh] complements. It therefore appears as if α works as a wh-scope marker present in the higher clause for a lower embedded wh-phrase, and as if this lower wh-phrase must move to that scope position in order to be interpreted. The best studied languages exhibiting wh-scope marking are Hindi-Urdu, German and Hungarian. Hindi-Urdu is similar to Korean in being a wh-in-situ language, with optional wh-scrambling. The classic references for the wh-scope marking construction in Hindi-Urdu are Davison (1984), Mahajan (1990), Srivastav (1991) and Dayal (1994).

5.2 Direct, indirect and mixed dependency

Consider the abstract representation of wh-scope marking in (26), where WH is a wh-scope marker, CP₂ is an embedded clause taken by a verb V that selects clausal [–wh] complements, and XP_{wh} is a wh-phrase in CP₂.

- (26) [CP₁ WH ... V [CP₂ ... XP_{wh} ...]]

Direct dependency approaches build a direct syntactic and semantic relationship between WH and XP_{wh}, whereas indirect dependency approaches assume that such a relationship can be built only indirectly, as a result of a direct syntactic and semantic relationship between WH and CP₂. Mixed approaches, finally, form a syntactic relationship between WH and CP₂ and a semantic relationship between WH and XP_{wh}. The fourth logical possibility, a semantic relationship between WH and CP₂ together with a syntactic relationship between WH and XP_{wh}, has not been taken up in the literature, and it is in any case difficult to see what such a relationship would look like.

5.2.1 The direct dependency approach

Wh-scope marking is taken literally under this approach. A scope marker is an expletive that marks the scope position of the wh-phrase, and a chain is created between the position taken by the scope marker and the position occupied by the wh-phrase at some level of representation. On this view, only the highest scope marker, which takes the Spec,C[+wh]

position, actually signals the scope of the *wh*-phrase; intermediate scope markers are purely syntactic devices. The approach has been used for German by van Riemsdijk (1982), von Stechow & Sternefeld (1988), McDaniel (1989), Rizzi (1992), Bayer (1996), Cheng (1997), Müller (1997) and Sabel (1998), among many others, and for Hindi-Urdu by Mahajan (1990), for whom a chain is formed after LF raising of both *kyaa* and the *wh*-phrase. This becomes apparent from the abstract representation in (27).

(27) [_{CP1} ... *wh*₁ ...] [_{CP2} ... *wh*₂ (... *wh*_n) ...]

Put simply, the direct dependency approach treats *wh*₁ as semantically inert and assigns matrix scope to *wh*₂ ... *wh*_n.

5.2.2 The indirect dependency approach

On this approach the *wh*-scope marker is not an expletive, and hence not a scope marker at all. It is an ordinary *wh*-argument that quantifies over propositions rather than over individuals, and it is moved to Spec,C[+*wh*] in languages with overt *wh*-movement, such as German and Hungarian, but stays in situ in *wh*-in-situ languages such as Hindi-Urdu. Dayal (1994) is the classic reference for indirect dependency. The approach takes *wh*₁ to play a crucial role in determining what the question quantifies over. *Wh*₂ ... *wh*_n do not have matrix scope but play an indirect role in matrix quantification, since CP₂ forms the restriction of *wh*₁.

5.2.3 The mixed dependency approach

The fundamental idea of this approach is that the syntax of *wh*-scope marking structures is essentially as it is assumed to be under an indirect dependency approach. The *wh*-scope marker is base-generated in a VP-internal position and moves to Spec,C[+*wh*] at surface structure in languages with overt *wh*-movement, and at LF in *wh*-in-situ languages. The embedded CP₂ in (26) is co-indexed with the *wh*-scope marker, as repeated in (28).

(28) [_{CP1} WH_i ... V [_{CP2i} ... XP_{wh} ...]]

There is no direct syntactic relationship between the scope marker WH and XP_{wh}. XP_{wh} moves to Spec,C of CP₂ at surface structure in languages with overt *wh*-movement and at LF in *wh*-in-situ languages. Thus far everything is as in a pure indirect dependency approach. The mixed approach, however, assumes that the scope marker is not an argument but an expletive. At LF, CP₂ moves to the position of WH, performing expletive replacement. By being in Spec,C of CP₂ at LF, XP_{wh} can gain scope over everything in CP₁, and CP₁ qualifies as a proper long-distance question. Semantic interpretation therefore proceeds exactly as in the direct dependency approach. This type of analysis has been pursued by Horvath (1995, 1997) and by Fanselow & Mahajan (2000).

6 Analysis and proposed treatment

6.1 *Wh*-expletives and the EPP in Hindi-Urdu

One thing is clear about *kyaa* in Hindi-Urdu and *ke* in Haryanvi: even though they have the shape of a very frequent *wh*-element, their behaviour in scope-marking constructions is different from what is usually seen in simple interrogatives, or, as I shall put it, is not canonical. In English, having expletives answers an EPP requirement, since English requires an overt

subject to appear at surface structure. The EPP requirement in Hindi-Urdu and Haryanvi is not of the same kind. Consider (29) and (30).

- (29) Hindi-Urdu *Raam kyaa jaanta hai?*
 Ram what know.PRS.M be.PRS
 ‘What does Ram know?’

- (30) Hindi-Urdu *Raam yeh jaanta hai.*
 Ram this know.PRS.M be.PRS
 ‘Ram knows this.’

In Hindi-Urdu the canonical object position is preverbal, and it is apparent from (29) that *kyaa* is in that same position. This question does not involve scope marking, and it is clear that it questions the object of the selecting verb. Take (30) to be the answer to (29) in a context where *yeh* is used to refer to something that denotes what Ram knows. In the absence of that reference, (30) is an incomplete answer to the question, and a referent for *yeh* would be sought by the parser; otherwise the answer would not provide the expected information. *Yeh* here stands in a cataphoric relation with its referent.

- (31) Hindi-Urdu *Raam yeh_i jaanta hai [CP_{2i}(ki) aaj baarish hogii.]*
 Ram this know.PRS.M be.PRS COMP today rain happen.FUT.F
 ‘Ram knows that it will rain today.’

Yeh refers to the embedded CP, and this fact is shown by co-indexing *yeh* with CP₂. *Yeh* is optional in a sentence of this type and can be omitted. To show this, the empty operator ϕ has been put in its place in (32) and co-indexed with CP₂.

- (32) Hindi-Urdu *Raam ϕ_i jaanta hai [CP_{2i}(ki) aaj baarish hogii.]*
 Ram know.PRS.M be.PRS COMP today rain happen.FUT.F
 ‘Ram knows that it will rain today.’

It should be noted that embedded clauses in Hindi-Urdu come to the right of the selecting verb.³ We now turn back to *wh*-scope marking constructions and extend the above understanding to them. For that purpose we question something that is inside the embedded clause.

- (33) Hindi-Urdu *Raam kyaa jaantaa hai ki aaj kon aayegaa?*
 Ram EXPL know.PRS.M be.PRS COMP today who come.FUT.M
 ‘Who does Ram know will come today?’

- (34) Hindi-Urdu *Raam yeh_i jaantaa hai [CP_i(ki) aaj Raaju aayegaa.]*
 Ram this know.PRS.M be.PRS COMP today Raju come.FUT.M
 ‘Ram knows that Raju will come today.’

- (35) Hindi-Urdu *Raam ϕ_i jaantaa hai [CP_i(ki) aaj Raaju aayegaa.]*
 Ram know.PRS.M be.PRS COMP today Raju come.FUT.M
 ‘Ram knows that Raju will come today.’

³ There are exceptions. When *yeh* is specified by a head noun such as *baat* ‘matter’, the embedded clause can appear preverbally.

Take (34) as the answer to the question in (33). I propose here that *kyaa* is a wh-expletive and not a wh-argument. This *kyaa* was inside the internal argument of the matrix verb, and it is satisfied by the element *yeh*. As we already know, *yeh* alone cannot satisfy the question and requires further information, which is sought here by the embedded CP co-indexed with *yeh* in (34). In cases where *yeh* is omitted, *kyaa* is satisfied by the empty operator, which is itself co-indexed with the embedded CP. The restrictions on the possible propositions are therefore imposed by this operator and not by *kyaa*. This solves the problem of embedded wh-phrases taking scope over *kyaa* in the matrix clause. The proposal postulates that the embedded wh-phrase is not taking scope, and neither is *kyaa*: both of them have their own elements to satisfy them. What *kyaa* does is satisfy the EPP and check the [*uwh*] feature in the matrix clause.

6.2 The position of *kyaa*, *yeh*, the empty operator and the embedded CP

If this account is correct, then *kyaa* occupies the internal argument position of VP. When *yeh* is overtly present it too occupies that same internal argument position of VP, and in the case where *yeh* is absent the position is occupied by the operator ϕ . All these elements are in complementary distribution, as the explanation given above makes clear. The exact position is discussed below.

Turning to the co-indexed embedded CP, in order for co-indexation to be achieved this CP must be base-generated as the internal argument of the matrix VP, with *kyaa*, *yeh* and ϕ at the edge of this CP phase, from where they can move to the edge of the matrix vP and so appear in the preverbal position. This gives us the correct word order as it is seen at surface structure. In addition, the embedded clause CP is generated as the internal argument of VP, which paves the way for the claim that embedded CPs originate preverbally and appear postverbally only after the process of derivation.

In an interrogative sentence, the [*uwh*] feature of raised *kyaa* is checked by the C head in the matrix clause, while the embedded wh-phrase has its feature checked by the C head of the embedded CP. These movements are driven by the EPP requirements of every phase-defining head.

This analysis does not, however, confirm the initial base position of *kyaa* and *yeh*. What is clear is that in the process of derivation these elements appear at Spec,CP of the embedded clause, whether they are base-generated there or moved there from some position below. This must be left for future research. The configuration is given in (36).

(36) [_{CP1} ... vP ... [_{CP2} ... {*kyaa/yeh*} ... wh-phrase ...] VP]

The movement of *kyaa* or *yeh* proceeds from the edge of CP₂ to the edge of vP. This also goes well with the canonical word order of Hindi-Urdu being SOV: the embedded CP is generated as the internal argument of VP, and the movement of *kyaa* or *yeh* to the matrix clause gives us the surface word order.

6.3 Extension of the proposed treatment to Haryanvi

The treatment extends to Haryanvi without modification, as (37) to (40) show.

(37) Haryanvi Raam ke ja:ŋɛ sɛ?
 Ram what know.PRS be.PRS
 ‘What does Ram know?’

- (38) Haryanvi Raam yo ja:ŋɛ sɛ.
 Ram this know.PRS be.PRS
 ‘Ram knows this.’
- (39) Haryanvi Raam yo_i ja:ŋɛ sɛ [CP_{2i}(ə̌k) aaj baarish hovɛgi.]
 Ram this know.PRS be.PRS COMP today rain happen.FUT.F
 ‘Ram knows that it will rain today.’
- (40) Haryanvi Raam ϕ_i ja:ŋɛ sɛ [CP_{2i}(ə̌k) aaj baarish hovɛgi.]
 Ram know.PRS be.PRS COMP today rain happen.FUT.F
 ‘Ram knows that it will rain today.’

Extending this to *ke*, we obtain (41) to (43).

- (41) Haryanvi Raam ke ja:ŋɛ sɛ ə̌k aaj koŋ a:yvɛga:?
 Ram EXPL know.PRS be.PRS COMP today who come.FUT.M
 ‘Who does Ram know will come today?’
- (42) Haryanvi Raam yo_i ja:ŋɛ sɛ [CP_i(ə̌k) aaj Shyam a:yvɛga:.]
 Ram this know.PRS be.PRS COMP today Shyam come.FUT.M
 ‘Ram knows that Shyam will come today.’
- (43) Haryanvi Raam ϕ_i ja:ŋɛ sɛ [CP_i(ə̌k) aaj Shyam a:yvɛga:.]
 Ram know.PRS be.PRS COMP today Shyam come.FUT.M
 ‘Ram knows that Shyam will come today.’

There is no difference as such between the treatment of the wh-expletive *ke* and the sentential expletive *yo* in Haryanvi on the one hand, and that of *kyaa* and *yeh* in Hindi-Urdu on the other; the same analysis applies. *Ke* is a wh-expletive which gets answered by the sentential expletive *yo*. *Yo* is co-indexed with the whole embedded CP in the deep structure because there is a cataphoric relation between them, the embedded CP being the antecedent of *yo*, and the adjacency of the two makes this co-indexation possible. *Yo* then moves out of the embedded CP while the indexation is still intact. In (41) the wh-expletive *ke* appears in the matrix clause and gets answered by *yo* in (42) and by ϕ in (43). The cataphoric relation links *yo* or ϕ with the embedded CP, while the embedded wh-phrase is answered inside the embedded clause. If the matrix clause did not have a wh-element, it would not be interpreted as a question, and it is to secure that interpretation that the expletive is required.

It might be asked why the expletive is not merged directly at the matrix Spec,vP position. If it were, we would have no basis for forming co-indexation syntactically. In the treatment above, adjacency solves this issue, because the expletive c-commands the embedded CP inside the embedded CP phase and the two are very close. It also lets us explain how the embedded CP comes to appear to the right of the verb even though the word order is SOV.

6.4 An alternative derivation

A further possibility for the proposed treatment is the following. Once the embedded CP phase is completed, the [*uwh*] feature on the C head is checked by the wh-word that is in its domain and is c-commanded by it. The wh-expletive is then merged at the edge of the

embedded CP, in a manner comparable to do-support in English. Since it is at the edge, it can move to the matrix Spec,vP in response to the EPP requirement of the v head; moreover, it enters into an Agree relation with the matrix C head and checks its [*uwh*] feature. The remaining features are also checked, and the derivation is interpreted at CI without crashing. A schematic representation of the proposed treatment is given in Figure 2.

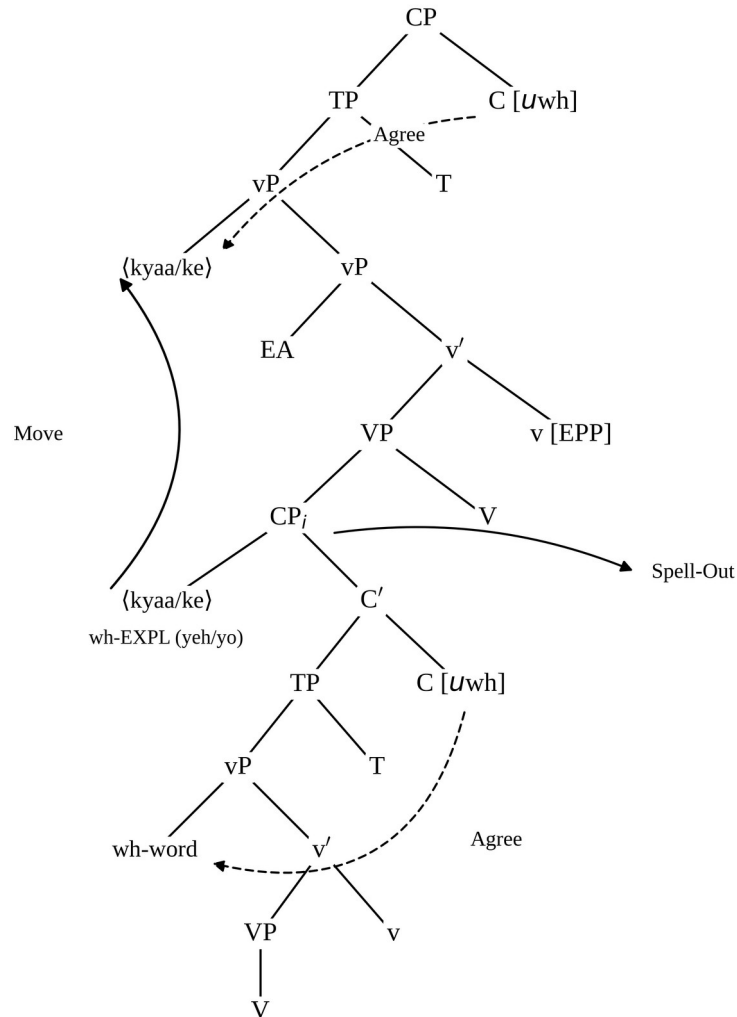


Figure 2: Schematic representation of the proposed treatment of the wh-expletive construction

In Figure 2, *kyaa* and *ke* are not co-indexed; it is the sentential expletive *yeh* or *yo* that is co-indexed with the embedded CP. The possible reason for this is that the sentential expletive and the embedded CP are generated close to each other in deep structure, so that after the movement of *yeh* or *yo* the co-indexation is needed to show that the two are related.

A different view of these constructions would be to take the wh-expletive to be merged directly at the matrix Spec,vP, so that it is not co-indexed with the embedded CP. The sentential expletive, however, would be merged at the embedded Spec,CP and would be co-indexed with the embedded CP through the cataphoric relation established under adjacency, moving to the matrix Spec,vP in response to the EPP requirement of the v head.

7 Conclusion

In Hindi-Urdu and Haryanvi the wh-expletive is not a scope marker. It serves a different function, in that it gives the sentence a question reading. Both languages are said to be of SOV word order. On the surface *kyaa* and *yeh* appear in the preverbal position, while the embedded CP appears to the right of the verb, and this gives the illusion that *kyaa* or *yeh* in Hindi-Urdu, and *ke* or *yo* in Haryanvi, are the complements of the verb. In the analysis given above it turned out that the true argument of VP is the embedded CP and that the wh-expletive is generated inside this CP, although the exact position of base generation is yet to be determined. The expletives move from the edge of CP to the edge of vP in response to the EPP requirement, which is driven by features on the phase-defining heads C and v. The wh-expletive must move to the matrix clause because the [*uwh*] feature of the matrix C head needs to be checked, both to avoid crashing at CI and for the sentence to receive a question interpretation. Since the expletive was generated in the embedded CP it is co-indexed with it, and locality makes that co-indexation the more plausible.

When the wh-expletive questions something, it is answered by *yeh* or *yo*, and through co-indexation it can place restrictions on the possible propositions accessible to the embedded wh-phrase. This in turn does not require a scope reading. If there is no wh-phrase in the matrix clause, the sentence will not be interpreted as a question. The derivation of a wh-expletive is not the same as that of an ordinary wh-word, so there is no requirement to treat the two in similar ways, and the movement of the wh-expletive should therefore have no effect on the wh-in-situ status of Hindi-Urdu or Haryanvi.

Further research may look at the possible position in which these expletives are base-generated and at whether that position is still compatible with the treatment proposed here. The different possibilities set out above can always pave the way for a better solution to the problem. For further elaboration, other constructions should also be tested and analysed, and any differences between Hindi-Urdu and Haryanvi should be analysed and checked as well.

Acknowledgements

This paper is a revised version of a research-based dissertation submitted to the Department of Linguistics, University of Delhi, in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Master of Arts in Linguistics in May 2023. I would like to give my warmest thanks to my supervisor, Prof. Tanmoy Bhattacharya, who guided me throughout this work; his guidance and advice carried me through all the stages of writing. I would also like to thank the two native speakers of Haryanvi who gave me their insights during this work.

Abbreviations

1, 2, 3	first, second, third person	FUT	future
ACC	accusative	IDA	indirect dependency approach
ATTR	attributive	LF	Logical Form
CI	conceptual–intentional	M	masculine
COMP	complementiser	MDA	mixed dependency approach
DAT	dative	NEG	negation
DDA	direct dependency approach	PFV	perfective
EA	external argument	PL	plural
EPP	Extended Projection Principle	POSS	possessive
ERG	ergative	PRS	present
EXPL	expletive	PST	past
F	feminine	REFL	reflexive
FOC	focus	SG	singular

References

- Bayer, Josef. 1996. *Directionality and logical form: On the scope of focusing particles and wh-in-situ* (Studies in Natural Language and Linguistic Theory 34). Dordrecht: Kluwer.
- Beck, Sigrid & Berman, Stephen. 2000. Wh-scope marking: Direct vs. indirect dependency. In Lutz, Uli & Müller, Gereon & von Stechow, Arnim (eds.), *Wh-scope marking*, 17–44. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- Bhatt, Rajesh. 2003. *Topics in the syntax of the modern Indo-Aryan languages*. Cambridge, MA: Massachusetts Institute of Technology. (Course handouts.)
- Cheng, Lisa Lai-Shen. 1991. *On the typology of wh-questions*. Cambridge, MA: Massachusetts Institute of Technology. (Doctoral dissertation.)
- Cheng, Lisa Lai-Shen. 1997. *On the typology of wh-questions*. New York: Garland.
- Chomsky, Noam. 2000. Minimalist inquiries: The framework. In Martin, Roger & Michaels, David & Uriagereka, Juan (eds.), *Step by step: Essays on minimalist syntax in honor of Howard Lasnik*, 89–155. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.
- Davison, Alice. 1984. Syntactic constraints on wh-in-situ: Wh-questions in Hindi-Urdu. (Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, Baltimore, 27–30 December 1984.)
- Davison, Alice. 1988. Constituent structure and the realisation of agreement features. In *Papers from the 24th Annual Regional Meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society*, 41–53. Chicago: Chicago Linguistic Society.
- Dayal, Veneeta. 1994. Scope marking as indirect wh-dependency. *Natural Language Semantics* 2(2). 137–170.
- Dayal, Veneeta. 1996. *Locality in wh quantification: Questions and relative clauses in Hindi* (Studies in Linguistics and Philosophy 62). Dordrecht: Kluwer.
- Dayal, Veneeta. 2000. Scope marking: Cross-linguistic variation in indirect dependency. In Lutz, Uli & Müller, Gereon & von Stechow, Arnim (eds.), *Wh-scope marking*, 157–193. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- Dayal, Veneeta. 2017. Does Hindi-Urdu have feature-driven wh-movement to Spec,vP? *Linguistic Inquiry* 48(1). 159–172.

- Fanselow, Gisbert & Mahajan, Anoop. 2000. Towards a minimalist theory of wh-expletives, wh-copying, and successive cyclicity. In Lutz, Uli & Müller, Gereon & von Stechow, Arnim (eds.), *Wh-scope marking*, 195–230. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- Horvath, Julia. 1995. Partial wh-movement and wh-scope markers. In Kenesei, István (ed.), *Levels and structures* (Approaches to Hungarian 5), 89–124. Szeged: JATE.
- Horvath, Julia. 1997. The status of ‘wh-expletives’ and the partial wh-movement construction of Hungarian. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 15(3). 509–572.
- Kidwai, Ayesha. 2000. *XP-adjunction in Universal Grammar: Scrambling and binding in Hindi-Urdu*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Lahiri, Utpal. 2002. On the proper treatment of ‘expletive wh’ in Hindi. *Lingua* 112(7). 501–540.
- Lutz, Uli & Müller, Gereon & von Stechow, Arnim (eds.). 2000. *Wh-scope marking* (Linguistik Aktuell/Linguistics Today 37). Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- Mahajan, Anoop. 1990. *The A/A-bar distinction and movement theory*. Cambridge, MA: Massachusetts Institute of Technology. (Doctoral dissertation.)
- Mahajan, Anoop. 1994. Toward a unified theory of scrambling. In Corver, Norbert & van Riemsdijk, Henk (eds.), *Studies on scrambling: Movement and non-movement approaches to free word-order phenomena*, 301–330. Berlin: Mouton de Gruyter.
- Mahajan, Anoop. 2000. Towards a unified treatment of wh-expletives in Hindi and German. In Lutz, Uli & Müller, Gereon & von Stechow, Arnim (eds.), *Wh-scope marking*, 317–332. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- Manetta, Emily. 2010. Wh-expletives in Hindi-Urdu: The vP phase. *Linguistic Inquiry* 41(1). 1–34.
- McDaniel, Dana. 1989. Partial and multiple wh-movement. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 7(4). 565–604.
- Müller, Gereon. 1997. Partial wh-movement and Optimality Theory. *The Linguistic Review* 14(3). 249–306.
- Mycock, Louise. 2004. *The wh-expletive construction*. Manchester: University of Manchester. (Manuscript.)
- Rizzi, Luigi. 1992. Argument/adjunct (a)symmetries. In *Proceedings of the North East Linguistic Society (NELS) 22*, 365–381. Amherst, MA: GLSA.
- Sabel, Joachim. 1998. *Principles and parameters of wh-movement*. Frankfurt am Main: Universität Frankfurt. (Habilitation thesis.)
- Schmidt, Ruth Laila. 1999. *Urdu: An essential grammar*. London: Routledge.
- Srivastav, Veneeta. 1991. Subjacency effects at LF: The case of Hindi *wh*. *Linguistic Inquiry* 22(4). 762–769.
- van Riemsdijk, Henk. 1982. Correspondence effects and the Empty Category Principle. *Tilburg Papers in Language and Literature* 12. Tilburg: Tilburg University.
- von Stechow, Arnim & Sternefeld, Wolfgang. 1988. *Bausteine syntaktischen Wissens: Ein Lehrbuch der generativen Grammatik*. Opladen: Westdeutscher Verlag.